Romania: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Romania is most exposed in downstream gas, downstream coal and upstream batteries, where its Energy Security is higher than only 17%, 30% and 34% of the other economies scored. In both downstream sectors, low and falling consumption per person pulls the score down.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in upstream nuclear, midstream solar and downstream solar, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 94%, 82% and 79% of the other economies scored.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks upstream batteries 1st among Romania's own sectors, with security need its largest part, and it is among the sectors with the most policy.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Germany highest for Romania, above all as a reliable supplier, and it is also Romania's 1st trade partner. The United Arab Emirates, its 4th trade partner, ranks 87th on Partnership Strength.[1,2]

1. Energy security risks and why

9 of Romania's 30 placed sectors, those where both scores can be compared with other economies, sit in the two low-energy-security corners. Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs. Compared with other economies, its Energy Security is lowest in downstream gas (0.41), downstream coal (0.43) and upstream batteries (0.19), all in the Secure corner. These scores are higher than only 17%, 30% and 34% of the other 98, 98 and 76 economies scored.[1]

In downstream gas and downstream coal, the score is low mainly because of energy access: consumption per person and its change. Gas consumption was 18.2 GJ per person in 2025, after a change of -12.9%; for coal the figures were 4.68 GJ per person and -39.5%. In upstream batteries, the trade category pulls the score down. On the trade deficit in these goods as a share of the economy, Romania scores higher than only 32% of the other economies.[1,3]

The high-priority sectors, upstream solar and midstream batteries, sit in the Upgrade corner, which pairs high opportunity with low energy security. On Energy Security they score 0.29 and 0.37, higher than 49% and 49% of the other economies scored. In upstream solar, trade pulls the score slightly down: on its trade deficit in these goods relative to its economy, it scores higher than only 22% of the other economies. In midstream batteries, foreign dependency pulls it slightly down: on the EU's announced 2035 share of world manufacturing capacity, which Romania carries, it scores higher than only 27% of the other economies. For context, its largest suppliers in midstream batteries in 2024 were Germany (23.5% of imports worth USD 559 m) and China (14.1%).[1,2,4]

2. Economic opportunities and why

16 of the 30 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners, where Economic Opportunity, how well placed a country is to create value, is at or above the sector median. Compared with other economies, its Economic Opportunity is highest in upstream nuclear, midstream solar and downstream solar, all in the Grow corner. These scores are higher than 94%, 82% and 79% of the other 174, 77 and 147 economies scored.[1]

In upstream nuclear, production pushes the score up: on production size and growth combined, Romania scores higher than 98% of the other economies. In midstream solar, foreign dependency and investment push it up. On the EU's announced 2035 share of world manufacturing capacity, which Romania carries, it scores higher than 79% of the other economies; on growth in investment, higher than 87%. In downstream solar, investment and consumption push it up: on growth in investment it scores higher than 96%.[1,4]

Among the high-priority sectors, upstream solar and midstream batteries have Economic Opportunity higher than 62% and 58% of the other 92 and 53 economies scored. Trade lifts upstream solar (export feasibility from related capabilities: 0.29, 2023); investment lifts midstream batteries (on capacity operating today, higher than 72% of the other economies). For context, the largest markets for its midstream solar exports of USD 6 bn in 2024 were Germany (37.9%) and China (7.8%).[1,2,5]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it puts upstream batteries 1st, upstream solar 2nd, midstream batteries 3rd, downstream solar 4th and upstream electric grid 5th among Romania's own sectors. The score of upstream batteries is 0.67, 0.025 ahead of the next sector; the sectors after it are almost tied, with gaps of 0.000, 0.007, 0.001 and 0.004. In the Secure corner, upstream batteries is lifted by security need: that part adds 0.242, against 0.131 for opportunity. The paper's framework associates the Upgrade corner, where the high-priority sectors sit, with building domestic capability.[1]

Romania's allied pick, its top upstream or midstream sector after a screen for a recorded resource base, is midstream batteries (0.64), 0.020 ahead of upstream nuclear. The screen removes upstream batteries and upstream solar.[6]

Policy activity counts the International Energy Agency's Policies and Measures records and the Climate Action Tracker rating, which favours low-emission technologies over coal, oil and gas. Country Insights splits priority (the Strategic Index without its policy part) and policy activity into thirds; both are high in upstream batteries, midstream batteries, midstream electric grid and midstream solar. No sector pairs high priority with the least policy, or low priority with the most. Among high priorities, policy is weakest in upstream green hydrogen and midstream green hydrogen, which rank 6th and 7th on priority. Romania carries the Climate Action Tracker rating Insufficient (November 2024) and has 73 Policies and Measures records.[1,7,8]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index rates partners as suppliers (Friendshore), as export markets (Partnership Opportunity) and, for middle- and lower-income partners, by Development Potential. From Romania's viewpoint it ranks Germany 1st, the United States 2nd, the Netherlands 3rd, the United Kingdom 4th and Italy 5th of 190 partners. Germany, the United States and the Netherlands score best as a reliable supplier; the best sectors for Germany include midstream solar, midstream electric vehicles, upstream green hydrogen, midstream wind and downstream batteries. The United Kingdom and Italy score best as an export market.[1]

Germany is also Romania's 1st trade partner on average across its energy-goods baskets, Italy its 2nd, the United States its 3rd and the Netherlands its 6th. Each of them is a priority partner with strong ties today, while the United Kingdom ranks only 15th among its trade partners. These partners share membership of NATO with Romania and sit in the same bloc in UN votes. By contrast, the United Arab Emirates, its 4th trade partner, ranks 87th on Partnership Strength; China, its 9th trade partner, ranks 44th. In UN votes, Romania and each of them sit in opposite blocs.[1,2,9,10]

As a partner to the coalition, Romania ranks 23rd of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads production of each upstream and midstream sector across coalition members, its largest derived share is 0.8% of midstream wind.[1,6]

5. Data notes and caveats

Paper baseline: 12 October 2026. Scores compare Romania with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Romania's shares are derived from its weight within the EU. The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Romania carries the EU's rating. Romania's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records. Trade figures count trade with other EU members. Each EU member carries the EU's announced 2035 manufacturing-capacity shares and electric-vehicle figures. The Country Insights page shows the data behind each figure.

Sources

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